

# ELI — New User Installation Guide

ELI v2.1.37 · Linux · Windows · macOS

August 2026

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## ELI v2.0 — New User Installation Guide

**Updated for v2.1.30 (July 2026).** The primary way to install ELI is now the **prebuilt installers on GitHub Releases** — ELI-Setup-<v>.exe (Windows), the .dmg (macOS, Apple Silicon), the .AppImage (Linux). The Linux AppImage and Windows installer are built and launch-tested in CI; the macOS .dmg is built on a Mac and provided best-effort (not verified in CI). First launch offers GPU acceleration (NVIDIA CUDA / AMD Vulkan; Apple Metal is built in) and a starter model sized to your hardware. Data lives in a per-user ELI\_v2 folder and survives upgrades; --fresh-start resets it. Everything below remains valid for **source installs** (clone + install.sh) and the classic portable tarball.

**Version:** 2.1.23

**Audience:** First-time users on Linux, Windows, or macOS

**Release page:** [https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI\\_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.30](https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.30)

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## 1. What you are installing

ELI is a **local-first AI assistant**. Everything runs on your computer:

- Chat and reasoning (powered by a GGUF model you download)
- Memory, knowledge graph, and habits
- Desktop GUI (PySide6) and optional web interface for phone/tablet
- Voice input (Whisper STT) and voice output (Piper TTS)
- Offline by default — no cloud account required

**Honest hardware note:** Best tested on **Linux x86\_64 + NVIDIA GPU**. Windows and macOS work; AMD and Apple Silicon are supported in code but less field-tested.

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## 2. Choose your package (same software, different wrapper)

| Package                   | OS                         | What it is                                    | Best for                                              |
|---------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Portable folder</b>    | Linux, Windows, macOS      | Extracted directory with scripts              | Tinkerers, USB drives, devs                           |
| <b>AppImage Setup.exe</b> | Linux only<br>Windows only | Single executable file<br>Graphical installer | Easiest Linux double-click<br>Easiest Windows install |
| <b>Source clone</b>       | All                        | Git checkout + <code>install.sh</code>        | Contributors, bleeding edge                           |

**Important:** None of the release downloads include the large **chat model** (~2-5 GB). That is downloaded during first-time setup. Voice models (~200 MB) and the memory embedder (~85 MB) are fetched automatically by the installer.

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## 3. Prerequisites (all platforms)

| Requirement       | Details                                                |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Python</b>     | 3.10, 3.11, or 3.12                                    |
| <b>Disk space</b> | ~10 GB free (venv + one chat model + voice)            |
| <b>RAM</b>        | 16 GB recommended; 8 GB minimum with a small model     |
| <b>GPU</b>        | NVIDIA recommended; CPU-only works but slower          |
| <b>Network</b>    | Required once during install (model + voice downloads) |

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## 4. Linux — Portable folder (recommended for control)

### 4.1 Download and extract

```
cd ~/Desktop
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.30/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable
```

### 4.2 First-time setup (run once)

#### Easiest — guided setup (recommended):

```
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

This runs eight steps automatically:

1. Welcome and Python check
2. Create `.venv` and install pip dependencies (`install.sh`)

3. Download a chat model sized to your GPU (or skip if present)
4. Initialize local databases
5. Download voice models (Whisper STT + Piper TTS) and memory embedder
6. Install app-menu icons (ELI v2.0, ELI Server, ELI Setup)
7. Open the graphical setup wizard
8. Launch ELI

#### Manual equivalent:

```
chmod +x INSTALL_ELI.sh RUN_ELI.sh install.sh
./INSTALL_ELI.sh
./RUN_ELI.sh
```

### 4.3 What the installer downloads

```
# Voice (STT + TTS) – automatic during install
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets

# Memory embedder – automatic during install
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --aux

# Chat model – offered in wizard, or run manually:
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --list # see options
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --auto # pick by VRAM
```

#### VRAM guide (NVIDIA):

| GPU VRAM | Suggested model              |
|----------|------------------------------|
| 8 GB     | Qwen2.5-7B Q4 (~4.5 GB)      |
| 12 GB    | Qwen2.5-14B Q4 or Mistral-7B |
| 24 GB+   | Larger quantised models      |

### 4.4 Daily use (after setup)

```
cd ~/Desktop/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable

# Desktop GUI
./RUN_ELI.sh
# or
./eli.sh
# or click "ELI v2.0" in your application menu

# Web server – local PC browser only
./scripts/eli_serve.sh

# Web server – phone/tablet on same Wi-Fi (with microphone)
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

#### Unified launcher:

```
./scripts/eli_launch.sh # desktop GUI (default)
./scripts/eli_launch.sh serve --lan --https # web server for phone
./scripts/eli_launch.sh both --lan --https # server + GUI together
```

### 4.5 Phone / tablet access

1. Start the server with HTTPS (required for microphone on mobile browsers):

```
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

2. The terminal prints URLs like:

```
http://192.168.1.118:8081/#token=XXXXXXX
https://192.168.1.118:8443/#token=XXXXXXX
```

3. On your phone (same Wi-Fi), open the **HTTP** URL first to connect.

4. For voice/mic, open the **HTTPS** URL and accept the one-time self-signed certificate warning.

#### Firewall (if phone cannot connect):

```
sudo ufw allow from 192.168.1.0/24 to any port 8081 proto tcp
sudo ufw allow from 192.168.1.0/24 to any port 8443 proto tcp
```

### 4.6 Linux — AppImage (double-click install)

```
cd ~/Desktop
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.30/ELI_v2-2.1.30-x86_64.AppImage
chmod +x ELI_v2-2.1.30-x86_64.AppImage
./ELI_v2-2.1.30-x86_64.AppImage
```

#### What happens on first launch:

- ELI copies itself to ~/.local/share/ELI\_v2
- Runs INSTALL\_ELI.sh automatically
- Shows a progress dialog, then launches ELI
- Later launches open ELI directly from ~/.local/share/ELI\_v2

#### Daily use after AppImage first run:

```
# From the installed copy:
cd ~/.local/share/ELI_v2
./RUN_ELI.sh
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Or use the app-menu icons installed during first run.

### 4.7 Portable vs AppImage — summary

|          | Portable folder                       | AppImage                           |
|----------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Location | Where you extracted it                | Copies to<br>~/.local/share/ELI_v2 |
| Start    | ./ELI_Setup.sh then<br>./RUN_ELI.sh   | chmod +x and double-click          |
| Updates  | Download new tarball, re-run<br>setup | Download new AppImage              |
| Data     | artifacts/ inside folder              | ~/.local/share/ELI_v2/artifacts/   |

## 5. Windows — Portable zip or Setup.exe

### 5.1 Download

From [https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI\\_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.30](https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.30):

- **Portable:** ELI\_v2-2.1.30-windows-x64.zip — extract anywhere
- **Installer:** ELI-Setup-2.1.30.exe — graphical install (if built)

## 5.2 First-time setup

### Easiest — double-click:

ELI\_Setup.bat

### PowerShell (full control):

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Desktop\ELI
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes
```

### Command prompt:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Desktop\ELI
install.bat
```

### Install flags:

```
# CPU only (no NVIDIA GPU)
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -CpuOnly

# Auto-download chat model after install
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -AutoModel

# Skip model download (wizard later)
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -NoModel

# Also install CUDA toolkit via winget
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -InstallCuda
```

## 5.3 Daily use

eli.bat

.\scripts\eli\_launch.sh gui

### Web server:

```
# Local only
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1

# Phone/tablet on LAN (add -Https for microphone)
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1 -Lan -Https
```

### Start Menu shortcuts (after install):

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\install_desktop_apps.ps1
```

## 5.4 Windows voice assets (if mic/TTS fails)

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

---

## 6. macOS — Portable or source install

macOS uses the same install.sh as Linux (Metal GPU instead of CUDA).

### 6.1 From portable tarball

```
cd ~/Desktop
curl -LO https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.30/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar
```

```
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

## 6.2 From source (git clone)

```
git clone https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0.git
cd ELI_v2.0
bash install.sh --yes
./eli.sh
```

## 6.3 Daily use

```
./RUN_ELI.sh
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

**Finder launchers** (installed by `install_desktop_apps.sh`):

```
~/Applications/ELI v2.0.command
~/Applications/ELI Server (Web App).command
~/Applications/ELI Setup.command
```

## 6.4 macOS system dependencies (optional features)

```
brew install tesseract ffmpeg portaudio
```

---

## 7. First-run wizard (all platforms)

After install, ELI opens a setup window. Complete these steps:

1. **Hardware profile** — ELI detects your GPU/RAM and suggests settings
2. **Chat model** — pick or download a GGUF model (required for replies)
3. **Onboarding** — ELI asks your name, work, answer style, and focus
  - Type your real name when asked (“What should I call you?”)
  - Say skip at any time to skip onboarding

**If you answered onboarding wrong**, reset and start over:

```
cd /path/to/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable # or your install root
export ELI_PROJECT_ROOT="$PWD" PYTHONPATH="$PWD"
.venv/bin/python <<'PY'
from pathlib import Path
import json, sqlite3
from eli.kernel.state import clear_user_name
from eli.onboarding.interview import clear_onboarding_state

clear_onboarding_state()
clear_user_name()
cfg = Path("config/settings.json")
s = json.loads(cfg.read_text())
s["user_name"] = ""
s["first_run_complete"] = False
cfg.write_text(json.dumps(s, indent=2) + "\n")
db = Path("artifacts/db/user.sqlite3")
con = sqlite3.connect(db)
```

```

for t in ["memories", "user_patterns", "kg_entities", "conversations"]:
    try: con.execute(f"DELETE FROM {t}")
    except: pass
con.commit()
print("Reset complete – restart ELI")
PY

```

---

## 8. Folder layout (where your data lives)

```

ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable/
.venv/                      Python environment (created by install)
models/
  gguf/                     Chat models you download
  embeddings/               Memory embedder (auto-downloaded)
  whisper/                  Speech-to-text weights (auto-downloaded)
  tts/piper/                Text-to-speech voice (auto-downloaded)
artifacts/
  db/                       SQLite databases (memory, habits, etc.)
  conversations/            Saved chat logs
  runtime/                  User profile snapshots
config/
  settings.json             Your preferences and model path
scripts/
  eli_serve.sh              Web server launcher
  eli_launch.sh             Unified launcher
  eli_setup.sh              Guided setup
ELI_Setup.sh                One-click first-time setup
INSTALL_ELI.sh              Install only
RUN_ELI.sh                  Launch desktop app
eli.sh                      Launch desktop app (alias)

```

---

## 9. Troubleshooting

### “No GGUF model found” / empty chat replies

Download a chat model:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --auto
```

Or set model path in **Settings** → **Model** in the GUI.

### STT error: “network disabled” / huggingface.co blocked

Whisper is not cached. Run:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

Then restart the server.

### TTS 503: “no voice model”

Piper voice missing. Run:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

### Phone mic does not work

Browsers block microphone on plain http://LAN-IP. Use HTTPS:

```
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Open the https:// URL on the phone and accept the certificate warning.

```
./scripts/eli_serve.sh: No such file or directory
```

You are in the wrong directory. Either:

```
cd /path/to/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Or use the full path:

```
/home/you/Desktop/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable/scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

### Only 9-10 GPU layers on 8 GB card

Use a smaller model (7B, not 35B). In the hardware wizard, pick Qwen2.5-7B.

### Re-run full setup safely

```
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

Safe to run multiple times — idempotent.

### Diagnostics

```
./eli_diagnose.sh
.venv/bin/python -c "from eli.setup.status import stage_checks; print(stage_checks())"
```

---

## 10. Quick reference — copy-paste commands

### Linux portable — full first install

```
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.30/ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh && ./ELI_Setup.sh
```

### Linux — daily desktop

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable && ./RUN_ELI.sh
```

### Linux — phone server with voice

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable && ./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

### Windows — first install

```
cd ELI
ELI_Setup.bat
```

### Windows — daily desktop

```
eli.bat
```

## Windows — phone server

```
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1 -Lan -Https
```

## macOS — first install

```
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.30-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh && ./ELI_Setup.sh
```

---

## 11. What happens during install (technical summary)

| Step                       | Script                   | Network?   | Size    |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|------------|---------|
| Python venv + pip packages | install.sh / install.ps1 | Yes (PyPI) | ~2 GB   |
| Memory embedder            | model_download --aux     | Yes        | ~85 MB  |
| Voice STT (Whisper)        | voice_assets             | Yes        | ~150 MB |
| Voice TTS (Piper amy)      | voice_assets             | Yes        | ~63 MB  |
| Chat model                 | wizard or model_download | Yes        | 2-5 GB  |
| Database init              | eli.core.init_data       | No         | —       |
| Desktop icons              | install_desktop_apps.sh  | No         | —       |

After install, ELI runs **offline by default**. Only deliberate actions (web search, model download) use the network.

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## 12. Getting help

- **Release page:** [https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI\\_v2.0/releases](https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases)
- **Issues:** [https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI\\_v2.0/issues](https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/issues)
- **Server docs:** docs/SERVER\_AND\_WEB\_APP.md (in the install folder)
- **Cross-platform notes:** docs/CROSS\_PLATFORM.md

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*ELI v2.0 — local, private, yours. This guide matches release v2.1.23.*